

THE UNIVERSITY OF HONG KONG
DEPARTMENT OF MATHEMATICS

CCST5037 Mathematics: A Cultural Heritage

Assignment 1: Group Project Plan

In this assignment, you will meet with your groupmates to form a plan for your project and give some feedback about what led to your choice of group project topic. Your group project plan should be between 200-400 words (1-2 pages) and include the following:

1. Together with a tentative title and topic for your essay, describe what led to you focusing on this topic for your group project.
2. Names and UID of group members and tutorial group (E.g., Toby 02 Wed 1100-1150)
3. The book(s) (or piece of work) you are going to write about, with a primary source and a basic list of references
4. A proposed “central theme” for your essay and how it fits within the course objectives.
5. a brief description of the proposed essay content, how this is related to the course learning outcomes.

Course Learning Outcomes
1. Appreciate and describe the beauty, the utility, and the "Way" of mathematics.
2. Comprehend and describe how mathematics was and is being developed as a work of human culture.
3. Investigate and describe the interplay between mathematics and other areas of human culture.
4. Investigate and explain the role of mathematics in the development of civilization.

The work should be your own; take care to avoid the pitfall of plagiarism. Generative AI can be used, but please use it responsibly. In particular, group members should understand the content of the project plan and be able to answer questions about the content upon request.

Only one representative per group needs to submit the plan on behalf of the whole group, which should be submitted before **16:55, October 16th, 2026 (Friday)**. You may submit the assignment multiple times, so it is suggested to submit an early version to avoid being penalized for late submission. Late submission will be penalized as follows:

- 1) 2% for submission within the first 3 minutes after the deadline, then
- 2) 5% for submission up to 10 minutes after the deadline, then
- 3) 10% for submission within the first 30 minutes after the deadline, then
- 4) 10% for every 30 minute period after that, up to 40% per day (so 2 hours-24 hours late would be 40% penalty)
- 5) On day 2: 10% for every 30 minutes, up to 40% per day (so 26-48 hours late would be 80% penalty)
- 6) On day 3, 10% for every 30 minutes, up to 20% (giving total 100% late penalty after 2 days, 1 hour).

In addition to receiving a score between 0 and 10 points, you will receive feedback on your assignment. In response to this feedback, you can submit an updated essay plan until **16:55, October 29th, 2026 (Thursday)**. Your assignment 1 score can be increased based on improvements to your plan in the interim. Even if you do not choose to submit an updated essay plan, you are strongly encouraged to carefully look at the feedback and take it into account when writing your group essay.